

Design Simulation Portfolio

with Methodological Annotations

From problem space to tested concept: the full design process arc applied to a real ALDA project.

PROBLEM SPACE	Exclusion of disadvantaged youth from sport (educational poverty) — anchored to the Sports 4 All project (Erasmus+, 2022-23)
HOST ORGANISATION CONTEXT	ALDA — European Association for Local Democracy, Vicenza · Project Cycle Management internship
PROGRAMME	MSc ICT & Development for Social Good · University of Turin · July 2026
CONCEPT PRODUCED	The Open Door Protocol



Sports 4 All — The Complete Design Process Applied

Project: Sports 4 All — "Encouraging social inclusion and diversity in sports" · **Host:** ALDA (partner), lead: Kirikù Social Cooperative ·

Prepared by: ICT & Development for Social Good, University of Turin · July 2026

PERIOD 06/2022 - 11/2023 (completed)	DONOR / PROGRAMME European Commission · Erasmus+	COUNTRIES France · Greece · Italy · Slovenia · Spain	SDG 10 — Reduced Inequalities
CONSORTIUM Kirikù (lead) · ALDA · TPV Novo Mesto · INNOVED · Mar Violeta	CORE BENEFICIARY Disadvantaged youth in educational poverty	DIRECT TARGET Coaches, trainers, educators	INTERVENTION TYPE Methodology + capacity building



WHY REBUILD AROUND THIS PROJECT

Sports 4 All is a **completed** project — which makes it perfect crash course material: its "archaeology" is real, its results are assessable, and its design choices can be critiqued and re-imagined without speculation. It also embodies the central pattern of all our previous work: **it changes the context around the beneficiary (training coaches), not the beneficiary's attitude**. Everything below dissects, tests, and rebuilds that logic.

1 Sensing — The Problem Space

"What is going on out there?"

FOCAL PROBLEM STATEMENT

"Disadvantaged youth in educational poverty are excluded from sports — and from the developmental opportunities sport carries."

The project's own framing is analytically sharp: educational poverty is **not just economic poverty** and not just a violation of the right to education — it is a **lack of opportunities across diverse, complementary, linked fields**. Sport is one of those fields: exclusion from it means exclusion from physical development, peer belonging, discipline structures, and adult mentorship simultaneously.

NATURE AND CONSEQUENCES

- **Multi-dimensional exclusion:** the child excluded from sport loses not one benefit but a bundle — health, socialisation, non-formal learning, protective adult relationships.
- **Compounding effect:** educational poverty derives from economic poverty but then reproduces it — fewer skills, weaker networks, lower resilience. Sport exclusion is one link in that reproduction chain.
- **Italian context (from our earlier problem space):** ~10% of the population in absolute poverty (ISTAT 2023), foreigners four times more likely to be poor, strong territorial divides — exactly the demographics of the "disadvantaged youth" this project names.
- **Connection to the democracy problem space:** a young person excluded from every civic-adjacent structure (sport clubs, associations) at 13 is the disengaged non-voter at 24. Sports 4 All and the local-democracy work address the **same population at different life stages**.

ARCHAEOLOGY — WHAT HAS ALREADY BEEN TRIED

- **The normative layer (1976):** the European Sports Charter for All (Council of Europe) called on governments to guarantee citizens the practice of sport — 46+ years before this project. The right exists on paper; the project exists because paper didn't deliver.

- **Fee waivers and subsidy schemes:** many municipalities offer reduced fees for low-income families — a supply-side fix that doesn't address why families don't apply (stigma, information gaps, forms).
- **Generic inclusion campaigns:** awareness posters and "sport for everyone" messaging — attitude-targeting, which our whole framework predicts will fail.
- **The gap Sports 4 All identified:** nobody had equipped the **coaches** — the human beings at the actual point of contact — with a methodology for working with educationally poor youth. The intervention fills a capability gap, not an awareness gap.

🔍 METHODOLOGICAL REFLECTION — PROBLEM FRAMING & ARCHAEOLOGY

Why this method: a focal-problem statement plus an "archaeology" pass (what has already been tried and why it fell short) was chosen over jumping straight to a root-cause diagram. The reason is sequencing: you cannot credibly build a problem tree until you know which causal layer is already "occupied" by a failed or partial intervention (fee waivers, awareness campaigns). Archaeology tells you where the unclaimed leverage actually is — in this case, the coach, not the family or the fee.

Alternatives considered: a straight **5 Whys** drill-down was considered first. It was set aside because 5 Whys assumes a single causal chain, while educational-poverty exclusion is explicitly *multi-dimensional* (the project's own framing) — a branching problem tree with cause clusters (built out fully in Stage 2) fits that shape better. A pure literature review of the sector was also considered and rejected as too broad for the time available; anchoring the archaeology specifically to what Sports 4 All itself and comparable municipal schemes had tried kept the scan relevant and falsifiable.

Quality control: every archaeology bullet is tied to a verifiable external reference (the 1976 Council of Europe Charter, ISTAT 2023 poverty data, observable municipal subsidy practice) rather than an assumed failure mode — this is what keeps the "gap identified" claim (coaches, not awareness) defensible rather than asserted.

Relation to purpose: this stage exists to earn the right to the rest of the document. If the archaeology is wrong — if awareness or subsidy design were actually the unaddressed gap — every downstream tool (WNF, journey map, POV, concept) would be aimed at the wrong lever. Getting this first move right is what makes the whole arc coherent rather than a chain of disconnected exercises.

STEEP-V — MACRO-ENVIRONMENTAL SCAN

Where the problem tree looks **inside** the problem, STEEP-V scans the **macro-environment around it** — external forces the project cannot control but must design within. Each force is classified by direction: ▼ **headwind** (works against inclusion), ▲ **tailwind** (works for it), ◆ **ambivalent** (depends on design). Every force is wired to an existing tool — actant, theme, POV, or concept.

DIMENSION	FORCES IN THE SPORTS 4 ALL PROBLEM SPACE	WIRED TO
Social	▲ Demographic winter: fewer children → clubs compete for members → inclusion becomes a survival strategy , not charity ▼ Territorial segregation (periphery vs. centre); ~10% absolute poverty; migrant families 4x more exposed (ISTAT) ▼ Leisure fragmenting into individualised screen time — the courtyard culture Karim comes from is itself eroding	Flips the power relation in POV 2 (clubs need Karim); feeds Theme 6 (belonging infrastructure thinning at both ends); economic cluster of the problem tree
Technological	▼ Online-only club info and digital enrolment exclude low-connectivity families; screens are sport's direct competitor for after-school hours ▲ WhatsApp-level tech is universal even in poor households — "Second Contact" needs nothing more than a coach with a phone	Spatial/Digital cluster; the JTBD "competing hire" is technological. Design rule: build on tech families already have, never on tech the project introduces
Economic	▼ Inflation eroding family budgets — sport is the first "non-essential" cut; grassroots clubs financially fragile post-COVID; municipal budgets skewed to competitive facilities ▲ Erasmus+ / CERV sport-inclusion funding lines stable and growing — the follow-up has a funding environment	Explains the club-manager WNF causally: inclusion fails as an unfunded burden, and the macro-economics are why the burden feels unfundable. Feeds "solidarity pricing" HMW

DIMENSION	FORCES IN THE SPORTS 4 ALL PROBLEM SPACE	WIRED TO
Environmental	▼ Heatwaves compress the outdoor training calendar (Veneto summers increasingly hostile); facility quality worst in poor neighbourhoods (unshaded, unmaintained) ▼ Urban densification eats informal play space — Karim's courtyard is a shrinking resource ◆ Green urban regeneration (including ALDA's own Vicenza work) could rebuild play infrastructure	Spatial cluster; journey map phase 1 (the courtyard as origin). The ambivalent force is a cross-project synergy inside ALDA's own portfolio
Political	▲ Sport inclusion is less politically contested than migration or civic advocacy — reaches migrant-background families without triggering the resistance a "migrant integration" project would ▼ Regional politics determine sport funding; Veneto priorities may not match project timelines ▲ Dormant 1976 CoE Charter as normative anchor; 5-country consortium insulates against any single national swing	Theme 4 (the dormant right); the Meloni-era context from the democracy problem space, applied with a twist; feeds "Charter Scoreboard" concept
Values	▼ Italy's competitive-performance sport culture (winning attracts funding and volunteers) structurally devalues participation-oriented coaching — the methodology swims against the cultural current ▲ Post-pandemic revaluation of community and belonging; generational shift among younger coaches toward mentorship over drill-sergeant authority ◆ Parental values — sport as childcare, discipline, or mobility ladder — vary by community and shape enrolment more than any fee level	Explains Theme 5 causally: the methodology dies not from neglect but from value misalignment with club culture. The follow-up must target club culture, not just coach skills

THREE NEW FINDINGS THE SCAN ADDS

- **1 — The demographic-winter tailwind:** clubs *need* Karim more than Karim needs clubs. This flips the power relation in POV 2 and gives the proposal narrative its strongest argument to club managers: inclusion is member acquisition, not charity.
- **2 — The depoliticisation advantage:** sport reaches populations that politically-framed projects cannot. Sports 4 All-type work is a strategic *entry point* for ALDA's harder civic goals — the same families, without the political resistance.
- **3 — The values headwind explains the output-survival problem:** the methodology's real enemy is not neglect but the performance culture. Theme 5 now has its cause — and the follow-up project has its true target: club culture change.

STEEP-V-DERIVED HMW QUESTIONS (FEEDING STAGE 4)

- **Social ▲:** HMW position inclusion as the club's survival strategy in a shrinking-membership market — so club managers pursue it out of self-interest?
- **Technological ▲:** HMW run the entire "Second Contact" follow-up on the one channel every family already has (WhatsApp) — zero new tech, zero training?
- **Economic ▼→▲:** HMW convert the inflation squeeze into the solidarity-pricing argument — every ordinary membership quietly funding one open place?
- **Environmental ◆:** HMW link ALDA's urban-regeneration projects to sport access — regenerated spaces designed as informal play infrastructure, rebuilding Karim's courtyard?
- **Political ▲:** HMW use sport's depoliticised status as the entry point for reaching families that civic-framed projects cannot touch?
- **Values ▼:** HMW make participation-oriented coaching a source of prestige inside a performance culture — a visible credential, an award, a ranking clubs want?

WHERE STEEP-V LIVES IN THE METHOD — AND IN PCM

STEEP-V belongs to **Stage 1 (Sensing)** as the macro-scanning layer: the problem tree looks inward, STEEP-V looks outward. Its outputs feed forward mechanically: **headwinds ▼ become the Risks & Assumptions column of the logframe** (PCM Phase 3), **tailwinds ▲ become the opportunity narrative of the proposal**, and **ambivalent forces ♦ become explicit design choices**. A STEEP-V scan that doesn't wire into the actants, themes and POVs is decoration — every force above passes that test.

🔗 METHODOLOGICAL REFLECTION — STEEP-V MACRO-SCAN

Why this method: STEEP-V was chosen over the more common **PESTLE** specifically for the added **Values** lens. PESTLE's categories (Political, Economic, Social, Technological, Legal, Environmental) would have missed the force that turned out to matter most causally — Italy's competitive-performance sport culture devaluing participation-oriented coaching (Values ▼, feeding Theme 5). A scan is only as good as its categories; here the extra lens paid for itself.

Alternative considered: a simpler SWOT was considered and rejected because SWOT collapses external forces and internal capability into one grid, which would have blurred the distinction this document relies on throughout — between what the project controls (methodology, training) and what it must design around (demographic winter, inflation, sport-culture values).

How correct implementation was verified: the rubric applied while building the table was mechanical and checkable — every single force had to (a) carry a direction arrow (▼/▲/♦) and (b) wire explicitly into an existing tool in this document (a POV, a theme, a cluster). Rows that couldn't be wired were cut rather than kept as filler. That discipline is what separates this from a generic "environment scan" exercise.

Creative engagement: the three "new findings" below the table (demographic winter flips the power relation; depoliticisation is a strategic entry point; the values headwind explains Theme 5 causally) are not restatements of the table — each is a synthesis that required connecting two rows across different STEEP-V dimensions. That cross-dimension connective work is the actual insight-generation step, not the scan itself.

2 Sensemaking — Structures & Patterns

"What patterns and structures explain it?"

PROBLEM TREE — CAUSE CLUSTERS (THE 6-CLUSTER METHOD APPLIED)

CLUSTER	CAUSES FEEDING THE FOCAL PROBLEM
Economic	Membership fees, equipment costs, transport costs; family economic hardship; underfunded grassroots clubs
Institutional	Clubs lack trained staff for inclusion; no methodology exists; municipal sports budgets skewed to competitive sport
Social	Stigma of subsidy applications; migrant-background exclusion; peer-group segregation by neighbourhood
Educational	Educational poverty as lack of linked opportunities; no bridge between school and sport worlds; parents outside information circuits
Cultural	Gender norms limiting girls' sport access; competitive-performance culture crowding out participation culture
Spatial / Digital	Facility deserts in poor neighbourhoods; club information online-only, excluding low-connectivity families

METHODOLOGICAL REFLECTION — PROBLEM TREE CLUSTERING

Why this method: grouping causes into six clusters (Economic, Institutional, Social, Educational, Cultural, Spatial/Digital) rather than leaving a flat list was a deliberate choice to make the tree *actionable* — a flat list of twelve causes tells you nothing about where to intervene; six labelled clusters let you ask "which cluster is this project actually built for?" and answer it (Institutional — the missing methodology).

Alternative rejected: a full affinity-diagramming session (sorting unlabelled sticky notes bottom-up) was considered, since it is often stronger at surfacing categories nobody expected. It was set aside here because the causes were already well-documented in the project's own sources rather than freshly gathered field data — affinity diagramming earns its value on raw, ungrouped material, which this stage didn't have.

What I'd do differently with more time: in a real-world version of this exercise, this cluster table would be built *with* coaches and club managers in a workshop, not derived solely from documents — the clusters are a reasonable analytical guess, not a validated participatory output.

ACTANT MAP — HUMAN AND NON-HUMAN

Human actants:

Disadvantaged youth (beneficiaries)

Coaches & trainers (direct target)

Educators

Parents / guardians

Sports club managers

Kirikù (lead partner)

ALDA project staff + PCM intern

Consortium partners (TPV, INNOVED, Mar Violeta)

Municipal sports offices

Non-human actants:

Membership fees (the gatekeeper)

Registration forms & subsidy applications

The methodology document (the project's core output)

Erasmus+ grant rules & reporting templates

European Sports Charter 1976 (dormant normative actant)

Sports facilities & their locations

Equipment (boots, kits — cost embodied in objects)

SDG 10 framework

Transport infrastructure

METHODOLOGICAL REFLECTION — ACTOR-NETWORK THEORY (ANT) ACTANT MAP

Why this method: a conventional stakeholder map (people, roles, influence/interest grid) was the default option, but it structurally cannot represent a fee, a form, or a 1976 charter as things that *act* — and in this problem, they do: the fee and the form are what actually filter Karim out, not any human decision. ANT's human/non-human symmetry was selected specifically because the early archaeology already suggested the gatekeeping was administrative, not attitudinal.

Alternative rejected: a plain RACI-style stakeholder matrix was considered and dropped for the reason above — it would have produced a map of well-meaning humans with no visible mechanism of exclusion, which is precisely the wrong diagnosis this project's own framing warns against.

How correct implementation was ensured: every non-human actant listed had to satisfy a stricter test than "is mentioned in the project" — it had to have a verifiable effect on someone's behaviour elsewhere in the document (the fee appears in the journey map as the trigger for withdrawal; the methodology document's fear of "being a PDF nobody opens" reappears as Theme 5 and POV 3). An actant that didn't recur elsewhere was not included, to avoid the map turning into a list-everything exercise.

Relation to purpose: this map is what makes Stage 4's "One-Line Form" concept and the whole "invisible pathway" design possible — without treating the form and fee as designable objects in their own right, the eventual solution would default to more coach training alone, missing the artifact-level fix.

WANTS / NEEDS / FEARS — KEY ACTANTS

ACTANT	WANT — SEEKING	NEED — MUST TAKE FROM SYSTEM	FEAR — WOULD PREVENT THE GOAL
Disadvantaged youth	Belonging, play, being good at something visible to peers	Free/affordable access; a coach who doesn't make difference feel like deficiency	Humiliation — being the one who can't pay, doesn't have the kit, doesn't know the codes

ACTANT	WANT — SEEKING	NEED — MUST TAKE FROM SYSTEM	FEAR — WOULD PREVENT THE GOAL
Coaches / trainers	Teams that function; personal competence; recognition	Practical methodology, training time, club backing for inclusion work	Being handed responsibility for "difficult" kids with no tools — and failing visibly
Parents	Safe, affordable development opportunities for their child	Clear information, no-stigma enrolment paths, trust in the adults involved	Hidden costs appearing later; the child being singled out or excluded
Club managers	Viable club: members, volunteers, funds	Funding that covers inclusion costs; trained staff	Inclusion as unfunded burden that drives out paying members
Methodology document (<i>non-human</i>)	To be used — adopted into daily coaching practice	Champions inside clubs; training that transfers it; language coaches actually read	The standard fate of project outputs: the PDF nobody opens after the final report
Erasmus+ rules (<i>non-human</i>)	Compliance, measurable outputs, timely reports	Consortium capacity to absorb and document	Non-compliance; unspent funds; unmeasurable "soft" outcomes

METHODOLOGICAL REFLECTION — WANTS / NEEDS / FEARS

Why this method: WNF was chosen over a standard empathy map (Says/Thinks/Does/Feels) because empathy maps are built for a single persona, while this problem needs the *same* three-question structure applied consistently across six actants — including two non-human ones. WNF's abstraction (want/need/fear apply equally to a person or a document) is what let the methodology and the Erasmus+ rules be analysed with the same rigor as Karim, without forcing a human frame onto them.

Quality control: the discipline enforced here was that "fear" could not be invented for dramatic effect — each fear had to be traceable to a concrete consequence stated elsewhere (Karim's fear of humiliation is confirmed independently by the journey map's inner voice in phase 2 and phase 3; the club manager's fear of "inclusion as unfunded burden" is confirmed by the Economic cluster of the problem tree). Where two tools converge on the same fear, that fear is trustworthy; where a fear only appeared once, it was flagged as an assumption rather than treated as fact.

Creative engagement: the genuinely non-obvious insight this table produced is that Karim's *need* is not simply "money for a fee" — it is "a coach who doesn't make difference feel like deficiency." That reframing (from an economic need to a dignity need) is what makes POV 2 possible in Stage 3; it would not have surfaced from a cost-analysis alone.

JOURNEY MAP — PERSONA "KARIM, 13, VICENZA PERIPHERY"

PHASE	ACTIONS	INNER VOICE
1 • Trigger	Plays football daily in the courtyard; friends join the local club; coach at school says he has talent	"I'm as good as them. I want to be on a real team."
2 • Attempt	Goes to the club with a friend; gets the enrolment form; sees the fee, the kit list, the medical certificate requirement	"I can't show this to my mother. She has other things to pay."
3 • Barrier	Doesn't return; avoids the topic with friends; the club never follows up on the kid who came once	"It's not for people like us. Whatever."
4 • Withdrawal	Courtyard football fades as friends are busy with club training; more time online, less structured contact with adults	"They're all at training. There's nothing here."
5 • Re-engage ★	A Sports 4 All-trained coach notices the drop-off pattern, contacts the school, brings Karim in through a no-fee pathway with kit provided quietly — no ceremony, no singling out	"Coach just said 'training is Tuesday, bring your cousin too.' That's it. I'm in."

The critical design detail in phase 5: the trained coach removes the barrier **without making the removal visible** — because the WNF analysis shows Karim's deepest fear is not the fee, it's the humiliation of the fee being waived publicly.

METHODOLOGICAL REFLECTION — JOURNEY MAPPING & A NAMED LIMITATION OF THIS SIMULATION

Why this method: a five-phase journey map (Trigger → Attempt → Barrier → Withdrawal → Re-engage) was chosen because the WNF table gives you actants' internal states in isolation, but not the *sequence* in which those states change — and the sequence is where the actual design opportunity sits (the barrier is silent, and nobody follows up; that silence is the thing to fix, not the fee amount itself).

Honest limitation, and what I'd do differently in a real-world context: "Karim" is a constructed composite persona, built from the project's own beneficiary description plus ISTAT demographic data — not a transcript of an actual interview. In a real ALDA internship, this journey map would be built from (or at minimum validated against) an interview with an actual coach or, ethically mediated, a real family, since a fictional persona risks encoding my own assumptions about what "feels humiliating" rather than what beneficiaries themselves report. Flagging this explicitly is itself a quality-control step: it tells the reader which parts of the document are evidenced (the fee/form/kit mechanics, which are documented) versus dramatized for clarity (Karim's specific inner voice).

Alternative considered: a generic "customer journey" template with satisfaction-score touchpoints was considered and rejected — satisfaction scores would have flattened exactly the qualitative detail (the specific fear of public humiliation vs. private exclusion) that turned out to drive the whole POV 2 / dignity-mechanism design.

SERVICE BLUEPRINT — THE SPORTS 4 ALL INTERVENTION (CONDENSED)

LAYER	WHAT HAPPENS
Evidence (what Karim sees)	A coach who behaves differently; a no-fee pathway; kit that appears; training sessions that use inclusive methods — Karim never sees "the project" at all
Frontstage	Trained coaches applying the methodology; educators running formal + non-formal activities; club welcoming routines
Backstage	Coach training workshops; methodology development; consortium coordination across 5 countries; ALDA project management; intern tasks: partner contacts, workshop logistics, translations, drafting reports
Support processes	Erasmus+ grant & reporting cycle; SDG 10 framework; CoE Sports Charter as normative anchor; national sport federation rules; municipal facility agreements

*The blueprint reveals the project's most elegant property: the entire intervention is **backstage from the beneficiary's perspective**. Karim experiences only a better coach — which is exactly right.*

METHODOLOGICAL REFLECTION — WHY PAIR A SERVICE BLUEPRINT WITH THE JOURNEY MAP

Why this method, and why not stop at the journey map: the journey map alone tells you what Karim feels; it says nothing about who is doing what to make (or fail to make) that experience happen, or with what resources. Adding a service blueprint (Evidence / Frontstage / Backstage / Support processes) was the deliberate second half of the pair, because it is the backstage row that surfaces Theme 5 — a project output (the methodology) with no funded afterlife. Without the blueprint, "the methodology risks being a PDF nobody opens" would never have surfaced from the journey map alone, since Karim never interacts with the methodology document directly.

How I ensured it was implemented correctly: a blueprint is only useful if every frontstage line has a traceable backstage cause and every backstage line has a traceable support-process dependency. The intern-task row (partner contacts, workshop logistics, translations, drafting reports) was included specifically to keep the backstage layer concrete and checkable rather than abstract "coordination happens" language.

THEME 1 • THE DIGNITY GATEKEEPER

Cost excludes twice — once economically, once emotionally

The fee blocks families who can't pay; the **subsidy process** blocks families who won't endure the stigma of proving they can't pay. Every actor's WNF confirms it: Karim fears humiliation more than exclusion; parents fear the child being singled out. Any fix that removes the fee but keeps the visibility of removal fails.

THEME 2 · THE CAPABILITY GAP AT THE POINT OF CONTACT

The system fails at its warmest touchpoint

Coaches — the adults with the most contact and goodwill — are the least equipped. They want inclusion but fear failing at it without tools. The pattern mirrors the democracy work exactly: the touchpoint actor (coach ≈ municipal front office) lacks the methodology, so goodwill converts to avoidance.

THEME 3 · THE INTERMEDIARY LOGIC

Change the adults, reach the child

The project never targets youth attitudes. It re-equips the context — coaches, educators, club practices — so the inclusive behavior becomes the natural one. This is the context-shift principle in its purest funded form: **the beneficiary and the target are different people by design**.

THEME 4 · THE DORMANT RIGHT

A 1976 Charter, a 2022 project

The European Sports Charter guaranteed this access almost five decades before the project. A right existing as text (non-human actant) with no enforcement loop stays dormant. Sports 4 All is what activation of a dormant normative actant looks like: methodology + training + funded consortium.

THEME 5 · THE OUTPUT SURVIVAL PROBLEM

The methodology's fear is being a PDF nobody opens

The project ended 11/2023. Its central output — the methodology — now faces the classic fate of project deliverables: no funding attached to its continued use, no indicator tracking adoption after closure. The feedback-loop-silence theme from the democracy work reappears as a **sustainability loop** problem.

THEME 6 · SAME POPULATION, DIFFERENT LIFE STAGE

Karim at 13 is Alessia's disengaged neighbour at 24

Exclusion from sport clubs and exclusion from civic participation follow the same structure: insider architecture, cost/stigma gatekeepers, untrained touchpoint actors, broken follow-up loops. Sports 4 All and local-democracy work are **the same intervention at different ages** — belonging infrastructure.

METHODOLOGICAL REFLECTION — DERIVING THEMES WITHOUT INVENTING THEM

How correct implementation was ensured: none of the six themes above were written first and then illustrated — each was required to sit at the intersection of at least two independent tools already built in this stage. Theme 1 (dignity gatekeeper) needed both the actant map (fee/form as gatekeepers) and the WNF table (humiliation as fear) to agree before it counted as a theme rather than a hunch. Theme 6 needed the journey map's age-13 profile plus prior problem-space work on disengaged 24-year-olds. This cross-tool requirement is the actual quality-control mechanism for "sensemaking" — it's what stops pattern-finding from becoming pattern-inventing.

Alternative considered: writing the themes directly from the archaeology/literature review, skipping the actant map and WNF steps, would have been faster — but themes built that way tend to restate the source material rather than generate a genuinely new angle (Theme 6, connecting two entirely different ALDA problem spaces, is only visible once actant + journey-map data are cross-read).

3

Stating our Point of View

"What do we believe is really going on — and why does it matter?"

THREE INSIGHTS (EACH PASSES THE THREE CRITERIA)

- **1 — Exclusion is administered, not chosen:** Karim doesn't drop out of sport; he is filtered out by a fee, a form, and a kit list — non-human actants doing gatekeeping no human decided on. (*Well-informed: WNF +*

journey map + ISTAT poverty data. Reframe: from "hard-to-reach youth" to "easy-to-lose youth" — the system loses them, they don't hide. So what: redesign the filters, not the outreach.)

- **2 — The coach is the system's highest-leverage node:** one trained coach changes the experience of every child who passes through — a multiplier no youth-targeting program can match. (*Well-informed: intervention logic + capability-gap theme. Reframe: capacity building isn't the "soft" part of inclusion, it IS the inclusion. So what: invest in touchpoint actors, measure at beneficiary level.*)
- **3 — Project closure is where impact goes to die:** the methodology has no post-project loop — no adoption tracking, no funding for use, no owner. (*Well-informed: project ended 11/2023, page lists no documents, standard Erasmus+ structure. Reframe: sustainability is not a report chapter, it's a design requirement of the output itself. So what: the follow-up project — and your internship — lives exactly here.*)

METHODOLOGICAL REFLECTION — THE THREE-CRITERIA INSIGHT TEST

How correct implementation was ensured: each insight above is written to explicitly pass three checks, shown in the italic parenthetical: is it **well-informed** (traceable to specific tools/data, not opinion), does it produce a genuine **reframe** (a before/after shift in how the problem is named), and does it carry a **so-what** (a concrete design consequence)? An insight that only satisfies "well-informed" is just a finding; requiring all three is what turns findings into design-usable insights.

Alternative rejected: generating a long list of 8-10 "observations" and picking the most interesting-sounding ones was considered and rejected — that approach optimises for novelty over usefulness. Capping this at three insights, each load-bearing for a different downstream POV (coach / club / methodology), forced prioritisation instead of breadth for its own sake.

FRAMES IN THE "AS IF... THEN..." FORMAT

FRAME	IF APPROACHED AS IF IT IS...	THEN...
Sport as a service	...a service with a hostile onboarding funnel (fee, form, kit list) that loses users at first contact,	...redesign enrolment: one-step, no-stigma, follow-up on every child who comes once and doesn't return.
Sport as a right	...a 1976 right that has never had an enforcement mechanism,	...build the accountability loop: public access data per club, municipal funding tied to inclusion metrics.
Sport as a feedback system	...a reinforcing loop where exclusion at 13 produces disengagement at 24,	...intervene at the earliest loop entry (the first club contact) — the cheapest leverage point in the whole civic-exclusion system.
Sport as jobs to be done	...something Karim hires for belonging and visible competence — with the courtyard and the phone as competing hires,	...design club experiences that beat the substitutes on the emotional job (belonging without humiliation) from day one.
Sport as an actant network	...a network where the fee, the form, and the kit perform the exclusion,	...redesign the artifacts: invisible fee waivers, one-line enrolment, kit as standard provision not charity.

METHODOLOGICAL REFLECTION — FIVE DORST FRAMES, NOT ONE

Why this method: Dorst's "as if...then..." framing was used to deliberately generate five *different* problem framings (service, right, feedback system, jobs-to-be-done, actant network) before committing to a single point of view. The purpose is to delay commitment: if the design question is stated too early, it locks in whichever framing happened to come first (very likely the "sport as a right" framing, since that is how the project itself talks about it).

Alternative rejected: going straight from the three insights to a single POV statement, skipping the frame-generation step, was the faster path and was rejected on those grounds — it would have produced a defensible but narrower POV, missing the JTBD framing that later turns out to justify the entire "Bring Your Cousin" and courtyard-inversion ideas in Stage 4.

Relation to purpose: each frame here is not decorative — every one of the five reappears explicitly as a named "frame" for a Stage 4 concept (Service→Second Contact, Rights→Charter Scoreboard, Systems→Early Loop, JTBD→Bring Your Cousin, ANT→One-Line Form). The frame table is the actual seed list for ideation, not a standalone exercise.

POV 1 · THE COACH

Actor needs to Need because Insight

Grassroots coaches need to **be equipped with a practical inclusion methodology and the club's backing to use it** because **they are the system's highest-leverage node — and their current avoidance of "difficult" kids is fear of unequipped failure, not unwillingness.**

Context shift: don't exhort coaches to be inclusive — train them, then make the inclusive move the easy move (no-fee pathway they can activate without paperwork).

POV 2 · THE CLUB

Actor needs to Need because Insight

Sports clubs need to **make the removal of barriers invisible to the child** because **the deepest exclusion mechanism is not the fee but the humiliation of the fee being visibly waived — dignity is the real gatekeeper.**

Context shift: redesign the artifacts (enrolment form, kit provision, payment process) so a subsidised child is indistinguishable from any other member.

POV 3 · THE METHODOLOGY (NON-HUMAN)

Actor needs to Need because Insight

The Sports 4 All methodology needs to **an owner, an adoption indicator, and a funded afterlife** because **a project output with no post-closure loop becomes a PDF nobody opens — and 18 months of consortium work dies with the final report.**

Context shift: sustainability written into the output's design — a hosting institution, a training-of-trainers cascade, adoption tracked as a follow-up project indicator.

THE SINGLE COMMITTED POINT OF VIEW

"How might we make the **first contact between a disadvantaged child and a sports club** succeed — by equipping the coach, redesigning the gatekeeping artifacts, and protecting the child's dignity — so that **belonging at 13 becomes the vaccine against disengagement at 24?**"

📌 WHERE THE APPROACH ACTUALLY CHANGED, AND WHY

The three parallel POVs above were not written in the order they appear. The **first working POV**, drafted straight after Stage 1's STEEP-V table, centred on the *economic* frame: "sports clubs need a solidarity-pricing mechanism because inflation makes inclusion an unfunded burden." It was a reasonable POV — it is still preserved below as an HMW and later folded into the Open Door badge's funding logic — but it was **not committed to** as the lead POV once the WNF table and journey map were built in Stage 2.

The reason for the pivot: the WNF table showed that Karim's fear was not the fee itself but the *visibility* of the fee being waived, and the journey map's phase-3 inner voice ("It's not for people like us") confirmed that the deeper mechanism was dignity, not affordability. A purely economic POV would have led to a subsidy-design intervention — which the archaeology in Stage 1 already flagged as a solution that had been tried and had failed for reasons unrelated to money. Recognising that meant discarding the economic framing as the *lead* POV and rebuilding around dignity/invisibility (POV 2) instead, with the economic insight kept as a supporting mechanism rather than the headline.

What this shows methodologically: the pivot happened because a later tool (WNF/journey map) produced evidence that contradicted an earlier framing (STEEP-V's economic HMW) — which is the intended function of running multiple tools in sequence rather than committing after the first one. A single-tool process would have shipped the wrong POV.

4

Imagining Alternatives

"What else could this be?"

Sports 4 All ended in 11/2023. The generative question is: **what would the follow-up project be?** One concept per frame — your starting portfolio for crash course ideation:

FOLLOW-UP CONCEPTS (ONE PER FRAME)

- **Service frame → "Second Contact":** a protocol every partner club adopts — any child who comes once and doesn't return gets one personal follow-up from the coach within a week. Measured: return rate. Cost: near zero. The journey map shows phase 3 (barrier) is where Karim is lost silently; this closes it.
- **Rights frame → "The Charter Scoreboard":** a public, municipality-level dashboard of youth sport access (places offered vs. neighbourhood need), activating the dormant 1976 Charter with the transparency mechanism it never had. ALDA's local-democracy DNA applied to sport.
- **Systems frame → "Early Loop":** a joint school-club referral pathway: teachers flag drop-off from informal play, trained coaches make the first move. Intervenes at the loop's entry point instead of waiting for the family to navigate the system.
- **JTBD frame → "Bring Your Cousin":** enrolment designed as social invitation, not application — kids join in pairs/groups through a coach's word, paperwork follows later and invisibly. Beats the courtyard on its own terms: belonging first, bureaucracy never visible.
- **ANT frame → "The One-Line Form":** a consortium redesign sprint of the three gatekeeping artifacts (enrolment form, fee process, kit provision) tested with families — treating documents as the design object, exactly the Sports 4 All logic extended from people to paper.

📌 METHODOLOGICAL REFLECTION — ONE CONCEPT PER FRAME

Why this method: generating exactly one follow-up concept per Stage 3 frame (five total) before any convergence work was a deliberate divergence step — it guarantees the ideation portfolio isn't accidentally dominated by whichever frame felt most natural (almost certainly the rights/charter frame, given the project's own EU-normative language). Forcing one idea out of the JTBD and ANT frames too is what produced "Bring Your Cousin" and "The One-Line Form," neither of which would have appeared from a rights-only brainstorm.

Alternative rejected: free-form brainstorming without the one-per-frame constraint was considered and rejected — unconstrained brainstorms tend to regress to the most obvious framing under time pressure, which here would likely have produced five variations on "better coach training" rather than five structurally different concepts.

THE HMW PORTFOLIO — TEN IDEATION TECHNIQUES APPLIED TO THE COMMITTED POV

The bridge from Stage 3 to Stage 4: each technique deliberately **distorts the committed POV** ("make the first contact between a disadvantaged child and a sports club succeed") to open a different solution angle. Each HMW below links back to the tool in this document that feeds it.

TECHNIQUE	HMW QUESTION	FED BY
Amp up the good	HMW build the club entry around what Karim already has — daily courtyard skill and passion — instead of what he lacks?	Journey map phase 1 (he already plays every day); Insight "youth aren't lacking motivation"
Remove the bad	HMW eliminate the fee-form-kit moment from first contact entirely, so no child ever faces the gatekeeping artifacts on day one?	Theme 1 (dignity gatekeeper); actant map — the fee, the form, the kit list
Explore the opposite	HMW make the club come to the courtyard instead of the child coming to the club?	Inverts the journey map — every failure happens on the club's territory; the courtyard is where Karim is competent
Question an assumption	HMW remove enrolment altogether — why does playing on a team require an application at all?	Attacks the deepest non-human actant: the registration form. The courtyard has no enrolment and 100% inclusion
Go after adjectives	HMW make the first contact <i>welcoming</i> instead of <i>administrative</i> , and the fee waiver <i>invisible</i> instead of <i>humiliating</i> ?	WNF: Karim's fear is not the fee — it's the visibility of the waiver. The adjective is the design target
ID unexpected resources	HMW leverage the friends already inside the club, the schoolteacher who spotted his talent, and older siblings as the enrolment channel?	Actant map — peers and teachers are present but unused actants; "Bring Your Cousin" prototyped this
Create an analogy	HMW make joining a club like joining a courtyard game — show up and play, belonging precedes bureaucracy? Or like a free tier — full access first, formalisation later and quietly?	JTBD frame: the courtyard is the competing hire — copy what makes it win
Play POV against the challenge	HMW make the club a place where being disadvantaged is undetectable — where a subsidised child is indistinguishable from any other member?	POV 2 (the club needs to make barrier-removal invisible) pushed to its logical extreme
Change a status quo	HMW make inclusion the default economics of the club — solidarity pricing where every ordinary membership quietly funds one open place — rather than an exceptional charity act?	Club-manager WNF: inclusion fails as an unfunded burden. Change the funding structure, not the manager's attitude
Break POV into pieces	HMW equip the coach? HMW hide the waiver? HMW provide kit without ceremony? HMW follow up on every child who comes once? HMW connect the school signal to the club response?	Each piece maps to a Stage 4 concept: coach → training cascade; follow-up → "Second Contact"; school signal → "Early Loop"; artifacts → "The One-Line Form"

WHAT THE PORTFOLIO PROVES — AND HOW TO USE IT LIVE

The ten techniques didn't generate ten random ideas — they **re-derived the existing concept portfolio from different angles** and added genuinely new ones (the courtyard inversion, solidarity pricing, enrolment abolition). That is the sign of a well-built POV: **it stays generative under every distortion**. Live use at the crash course: when an ideation group stalls, don't push for "more ideas" — pick one technique and re-run the POV through it. **"We've been removing the bad. What's the amp-up-the-good version?"** One sentence restarts a dead session.

Why ten HMW-distortion techniques rather than brainwriting: the classic group technique for this stage would be **brainwriting** (silent, round-robin idea generation across several participants, building on each other's written ideas). It was not used here, and that is a limitation of the simulation worth naming rather than hiding: brainwriting requires multiple real participants generating ideas independently before convergence, and this document was produced by one person working from documented sources, not a workshop group. What was used instead — running the single committed POV through ten distinct, named distortion techniques (amp up the good, remove the bad, explore the opposite, question an assumption, etc.) — is a legitimate individual substitute for divergent thinking, because each technique forces a genuinely different cognitive move on the same material, which is what multiple participants would otherwise provide through different perspectives. It is not a full substitute, though, and I want to be explicit about that rather than imply equivalence.

What I would do differently in a real-world context: with more time and real access to stakeholders, this stage would run as an actual brainwriting session with 4-6 participants — ideally including a coach, a club manager, and a parent, not only project staff — writing independently for a fixed period and passing sheets, before the ten-technique HMW pass is used to *organise and extend* what the group produced rather than to generate ideas alone. The individual method used here is best understood as a rigorous placeholder for that group process, not a replacement for it.

How HMW substantiveness was checked: each of the ten HMW questions had to satisfy two tests — (1) it distorts the committed POV in a way specific to its named technique (not a generic rewording), and (2) it is traceable to a concrete tool elsewhere in the document, shown in the "Fed by" column. An HMW that couldn't cite its source tool was reworked or dropped. This is what stops an HMW list from becoming ten interchangeable "how might we help Karim" restatements.

Evidence of creative engagement: the "Question an assumption" row (removing enrolment altogether) and the "Explore the opposite" row (the club comes to the courtyard) are the two genuinely novel outputs of this pass — neither existed in the Stage 3 frames or the five follow-up concepts. Both get folded into the final concept in the synthesis stage below, which is the actual test of whether an ideation session produced something usable rather than merely divergent.



From Ideas to Intervention — Concept Synthesis

"Which ideas — or parts of ideas — achieve the change defined in the POV?"

The bridge from ideation to intervention: ideas are **not standalone solutions but components**. They are evaluated against the POV (who needs to do what differently), the valuable fragments are synthesised into **one coherent design concept**, the concept is articulated through a design artifact, and only its **riskiest assumptions** are prototyped. HMW questions are disposable — the concept must emerge from critical reflection, not rigid adherence to earlier frameworks.

STEP 1 — EVALUATING THE IDEAS AGAINST THE POV

IDEA FROM THE PORTFOLIO	VERDICT	REASON
"Second Contact" follow-up	Keep whole	Directly serves the POV — closes the exact loop where Karim is lost (journey phase 3)
"One-Line Form" + invisible waiver + kit without ceremony	Keep as components	Together they are the dignity mechanism — POV 2's context shift made operational
"Bring Your Cousin" social enrolment	Keep	Serves the belonging job (JTBD) — beats the courtyard on its own terms
WhatsApp as channel (STEEP-V ▲)	Keep as infrastructure	The tech families already have — zero new tools, zero training
Prestige credential for inclusive coaching (STEEP-V Values HMW)	Keep as sustainability engine	Converts the values headwind into the adoption motor — solves Theme 5 (output survival)

IDEA FROM THE PORTFOLIO	VERDICT	REASON
"Charter Scoreboard" / municipal dashboards	Set aside	Valuable but serves a different actor (municipalities) — a separate concept for a separate proposal
Courtyard inversion (club comes to the child)	Fold principle only	Operationally heavy as a programme; its principle — <i>the club moves first</i> — is absorbed into Second Contact

METHODOLOGICAL REFLECTION — SYNTHESIS CRITERIA

Why this method: evaluating every idea explicitly against the committed POV (rather than against "which idea is most exciting" or "most feasible") was chosen because the ideation stage deliberately over-generated: ten HMWs plus five concepts is more than one project can hold. A verdict column with a stated reason per idea keeps the convergence step auditable — anyone reading this document can check whether "keep" or "set aside" was justified, rather than trusting an unexplained shortlist.

Alternative rejected: a weighted scoring matrix (impact × feasibility × cost, numerically scored) was considered. It was rejected for this stage because false precision — assigning a "7/10 feasibility" to an untested idea like solidarity pricing — would have implied a confidence the ideas don't yet have. A qualitative keep/fold/set-aside verdict with a written reason is more honest about the actual uncertainty at this point in the process.

Relation to purpose: note that "Charter Scoreboard" is set aside not because it's weak, but because it serves a *different actor* (municipalities, not clubs/coaches) — keeping the concept focused on a single addressable actor is what makes "The Open Door Protocol" buildable as one coherent thing rather than a bundle of unrelated good ideas.

STEP 2 — THE SYNTHESISED DESIGN CONCEPT

"THE OPEN DOOR PROTOCOL"

A club-level certification and practice package that makes the first contact of any disadvantaged child succeed — **invisibly**. One coherent intervention, four integrated components: **(1) The trained coach** — Sports 4 All methodology extended with first-contact training: how to spot, welcome, and retain a child like Karim. **(2) The invisible pathway** — one-line enrolment, fee settled silently between club and municipality/fund, kit as standard provision: a subsidised child is indistinguishable from any member. **(3) Second Contact** — every child who comes once and doesn't return receives one personal WhatsApp follow-up from the coach within a week. **(4) The Open Door badge** — clubs completing all three earn a visible certification carrying prestige and priority access to municipal facilities and funding — converting the values headwind into the adoption engine, and riding the demographic-winter tailwind: **clubs need Karim more than Karim needs clubs**. Every component maps to a POV: the coach (POV 1), the club's artifacts (POV 2), the methodology's afterlife (POV 3 — solved by the badge making adoption self-sustaining).

STEP 3 — THE ARTIFACT: FUTURE-STATE JOURNEY MAP (KARIM, RE-RUN THROUGH THE OPEN DOOR PROTOCOL)

PHASE	KARIM'S FUTURE-STATE EXPERIENCE	INNER VOICE	BACKSTAGE (BLUEPRINT LAYER) — WHAT THE CLUB DOES
1 • Trigger	Plays in the courtyard; the school coach mentions him to the club — the club moves first	"The coach from the club asked about me?"	School-club referral link active; trained coach monitors informal-play signals (Early Loop principle)
2 • First contact	Coach invites him directly: "Training is Tuesday — bring your cousin." No form, no fee mentioned, no kit list	"That's it? I just... come?"	One-line enrolment completed by the coach; fee routed silently to the municipal fund; kit pulled from standard provision stock
3 • Barrier → Belonging	Trains with the team from day one; indistinguishable from any other member	"I'm on a real team."	Coach applies the Sports 4 All inclusion methodology; club dignity-protocol active: no public reference to subsidy, ever

PHASE	KARIM'S FUTURE-STATE EXPERIENCE	INNER VOICE	BACKSTAGE (BLUEPRINT LAYER) — WHAT THE CLUB DOES
4 · Withdrawal → Safety net	Misses two weeks (family issue) — receives one personal WhatsApp from the coach: "We missed you Tuesday. See you next week?"	"They noticed I was gone."	Second Contact protocol: automatic flag on absence, one personal follow-up within 7 days, logged for the club's badge renewal
5 · Anchored	A season later: still playing, brings his cousin, the courtyard and the club coexist	"This is my club."	Club retention data feeds the Open Door badge renewal; badge secures priority facility slots; ALDA aggregates data for the EU report — <i>and sends results back to families</i> (loop closed both ways)

Artifact choice per the synthesis method: journey map because the concept's value lives in an experience (what first contact **feels** like); the blueprint column because the invisibility mechanism — the whole point — is by definition backstage.

STEP 3B — THE FULL WORKSHOP ARTIFACT (AMPARO FORMAT): KARIM'S FUTURE-STATE BOARD



PERSONA

Karim

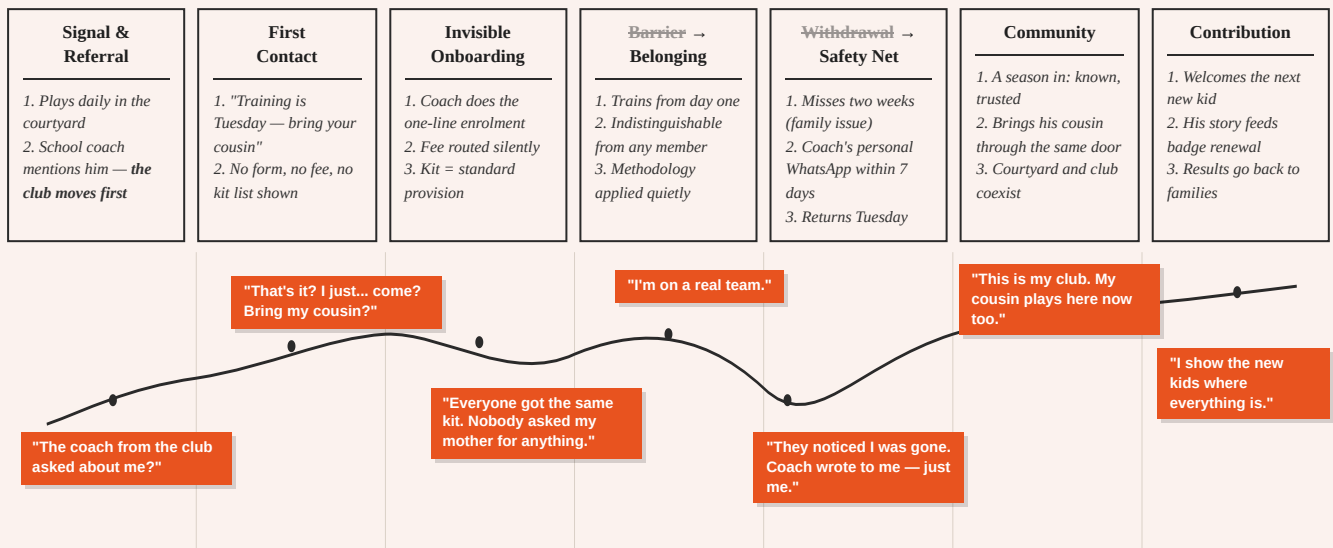
13 · Vicenza periphery · courtyard footballer

SCENARIO (FUTURE STATE)

Karim's neighbourhood club holds the Open Door badge: Sports 4 All-trained coach, one-line enrolment, invisible fee routing, Second Contact safety net. This board shows his experience when the concept works.

EXPECTATIONS & GOALS

1. Play on a real team and be recognised for his skill
2. Belong — without ever being marked as "the subsidised kid"



Questions

- Can the invisible pathway stay invisible in small communities where everyone knows everyone — is discretion possible in a paese where the club treasurer is a neighbour?
- How does the protocol account for children whose access is mediated by another person — a consenting parent, a translating sibling, a guardian who distrusts institutions? Who is the real first contact in those families?
- What is the role of the school coach / teacher as the referral node — and what happens in schools where no adult is watching the courtyard?
- Second Contact works when a coach-child relationship exists; what is the safety net for the child who came once and was never noticed at all?

Insights & Opportunities

- The belonging → community → contribution sequence (phases 4–7) is the experience's **core loop** — the same pattern the Amparo map identified. How do we maximise its stickiness, and ensure a version reaches children in clubs without the badge?
- Phase 7 turns Karim from beneficiary into infrastructure: every retained child lowers the cost of the next inclusion — **the protocol compounds**. The follow-up proposal should claim this multiplier explicitly.
- The emotional low is no longer structural (old Barrier/Withdrawal) but circumstantial (a family issue) — and the system now responds. That is the measurable difference between current-state and future-state: same child, same events, different architecture.
- This board doubles as the prototype script: phase 2 = the dignity role-play, phase 5 = the coach-adoption WhatsApp test, phase 7 = the badge-value club-manager interview — the three risky assumptions live at three visible points on the journey.

STEP 4 — RISKY ASSUMPTIONS TO PROTOTYPE (AND WHAT NOT TO PROTOTYPE)

ASSUMPTION	RISK LEVEL	PROTOTYPE — TARGETED, DISPOSABLE, TESTING ONLY THIS
Dignity assumption	Highest	Will families enrol through the invisible pathway — or does even a discreet process feel exposing? Prototype: role-play the enrolment conversation with real parents (the method's ultrasound example applied)
Coach adoption assumption	High	Will coaches actually send the Second Contact message — or does it feel intrusive to them? Prototype: 2 weeks, 3 coaches, real WhatsApp follow-ups; count sends and responses
Badge value assumption	Medium	Do clubs want the certification enough to change practice? Prototype: paper mock-up of the badge and its benefits, tested in interviews with 5 Veneto club managers
WhatsApp works technically	Not risky	Not prototyped — universal, proven infrastructure
Sports 4 All methodology is sound	Not risky	Not prototyped — validated by the 2022-23 implementation across 5 countries

A prototype is not the concept — it is a temporary, disposable artifact testing one assumption where uncertainty is highest and failure would undermine the whole intervention.

METHODOLOGICAL REFLECTION — WHY ONLY THREE ASSUMPTIONS GET PROTOTYPED, AND THE BIGGEST REAL-WORLD GAP IN THIS DOCUMENT

Why this method: prototyping was scoped to the two or three *highest-risk, highest-consequence* assumptions (dignity, coach adoption, badge value) rather than either (a) prototyping everything, which wastes effort on assumptions already well-evidenced elsewhere in the document, or (b) skipping prototyping and moving straight to a pilot, which risks discovering a fatal flaw — e.g. that even a discreet enrolment process still feels exposing in a small town — only after real resources are committed.

Alternative rejected: building a full pilot directly in one Veneto club, skipping formal prototyping, was considered as a faster route to real evidence. It was rejected because the dignity assumption specifically concerns social perception in small, tightly-networked communities (the "paese where the club treasurer is a neighbour" question raised on the workshop board) — a failure there is reputationally costly for the club and the child, which is exactly the kind of risk a cheap, disposable prototype (a role-play, not a live enrolment) exists to de-risk first.

What I would improve with more time / in a real-world context — the single biggest gap: this document describes what should be prototyped and how, but the prototypes themselves were not actually run — there was no access to real families, coaches, or club managers within the scope of this simulation. That is the most significant limitation of the whole exercise: the entire Open Door Protocol concept rests on three assumptions that remain, at this point, informed hypotheses rather than tested findings. A real internship phase would begin exactly here — running the three prototypes listed, in the order listed (dignity first, since it's rated highest risk), before any commitment to the badge or the funding model.

5 Transforming & Integrating — PCM & Your Internship

"How does this become real and stick?"

SPORTS 4 ALL MAPPED ONTO THE PCM CYCLE (AS-IMPLEMENTED + FOLLOW-UP)

PCM PHASE	WHAT SPORTS 4 ALL DID (2022-23)	WHAT THE FOLLOW-UP WOULD DO — AND THE INTERN'S ROLE
1 • Programming	Aligned with Erasmus+ inclusion priorities and SDG 10	Scan current Erasmus+ / CERV calls for sport-inclusion windows — <i>intern: donor call monitoring, summary notes</i>

PCM PHASE	WHAT SPORTS 4 ALL DID (2022-23)	WHAT THE FOLLOW-UP WOULD DO — AND THE INTERN'S ROLE
2 • Identification	Named educational poverty as the problem; coaches as the gap	Use this document's problem tree + WNF as the needs analysis; gather evidence on methodology adoption since closure — <i>intern: partner outreach, data collection</i>
3 • Formulation	Designed methodology development + coach training as twin outputs	Flip the POV statements into Specific Objectives; write "Second Contact" and "One-Line Form" as Activities with indicators — <i>intern: logframe drafting, proposal sections, translations</i>
4 • Implementation	Delivered trainings and workshops across 5 countries	Pilot in Veneto clubs via ALDA's local network — <i>intern: workshop logistics, partner coordination, documentation</i>
5 • Evaluation	Reported to Erasmus+; project closed 11/2023	Add the missing loop: adoption tracking, return-rate measurement, participant-facing results communication — <i>intern: interim/final report drafting, indicator tracking</i>

METHODOLOGICAL REFLECTION — WHY MAP ONTO PCM AT ALL

Why this method: the design tools in Stages 1–4 (problem tree, actant map, WNF, journey map, POV, HMW, synthesis) are largely design-research vocabulary; PCM (Project Cycle Management) is the EU-funding vocabulary that ALDA and Erasmus+ actually operate in. Mapping the design concept onto PCM's five phases is not a formality — it's the translation step that makes "The Open Door Protocol" fundable rather than merely a good idea. Without it, the concept stays a design artifact; with it, it becomes a proposal structure (Specific Objectives, Activities, indicators) that a real consortium could submit.

Alternative rejected: stopping the document at the synthesised concept and prototyping plan (end of Stage 4→5) was considered — the design work is arguably "complete" at that point. It was rejected because the exam brief and the internship context this document is built for both require the output to be usable in a real EU project cycle, not just a design portfolio; skipping PCM would leave the most practically useful translation undone.

Relation to broader purpose: this is also where the intern's actual role becomes concrete and checkable (donor-call monitoring, needs-analysis drafting, logframe drafting, workshop logistics, indicator tracking) rather than an abstract "supports the project" description — it ties the entire design-thinking arc back to a specific, assignable set of tasks.

THE META-PATTERN — CARRIED OVER AND CONFIRMED

The democracy synthesis ended with: **"a system of open loops — the highest-leverage design work is closing them."** Sports 4 All confirms it at every level: the child lost after one visit (open loop), the right dormant since 1976 (open loop), the methodology with no afterlife (open loop), the excluded 13-year-old who becomes the disengaged 24-year-old (the longest open loop of all). **One point of view now covers both problem spaces: exclusion is an open-loop phenomenon, and every concept in this document is a loop-closing device.** Say that sentence at the crash course, and everything you've built — both problem spaces, all ten tools — stands behind it.

How the approach evolved across the process: the arc did not move in a straight line from problem to solution. The clearest pivot is documented in Stage 3 — the lead POV shifted from an economic framing (solidarity pricing) to a dignity framing once the WNF table and journey map surfaced humiliation as the deeper mechanism. A second, smaller shift happened between Stage 4 and synthesis: the courtyard-inversion concept, initially proposed as a standalone programme ("the club comes to the child"), turned out to be operationally too heavy to stand alone and was folded into "Second Contact" as a principle ("the club moves first") rather than kept as its own workstream. Both changes are left visible in the document rather than smoothed over, because the exam brief specifically asks whether and why the approach changed.

What I would improve, expand, or do differently with more time or in a real-world context, drawn together: (1) every persona and most of the qualitative claims (Karim, the specific fears, the emotion curve) are constructed from documented project material and general poverty/sport-inclusion literature, not from real interviews — a genuine internship phase would start by testing these against actual coaches, club managers, and — ethically, via consent and safeguarding protocols appropriate for minors — families; (2) the ideation stage substituted individual, ten-technique HMW distortion for group brainwriting, which is a defensible but not equivalent method — a real workshop with mixed participants would very likely surface ideas this single-author pass could not; (3) the three riskiest assumptions were identified and a prototyping plan was designed, but no prototype was actually run — that is the concrete next step, in priority order (dignity → coach adoption → badge value); (4) the STEEP-V forces are argued qualitatively; a real proposal would back the strongest claims (e.g. the demographic-winter tailwind) with actual regional club-membership data rather than plausible reasoning alone.

Overall relation to purpose: every tool in this document was chosen not for its own sake but because it closed a specific gap the previous tool left open — archaeology before the problem tree, STEEP-V before the HMWs, WNF before the journey map, the journey map before the blueprint, insights before frames, frames before concepts, ideation before synthesis, synthesis before prototyping, and prototyping before PCM. Where a tool's contribution wasn't load-bearing for something downstream, it was either cut or explicitly marked as a supporting rather than central method above.